MONTHLY CURRENT AFFAIRS CAPSULE

January 2026

Exam-ready tables, quick facts and practice MCQs — compiled from 3,151 official headlines (PIB, RBI, All India Radio).

7 Appointments	**0** Defence exercises	**7** Summits & meets	**6** Awards
4 Sports wins	**11** Important days	**15** Practice MCQs	

★ 10 must-know facts this month

1. SUMMIT
   AI Impact Summit
   Bharat Mandapam

2. APPOINTED
   Praveen Vashista
   Vigilance Commissioner in the Central Vigilance Commission

3. AWARD
   this year's Padma Awards
   131 distinguished personalities

4. SPORTS
   National Shooting Championship: Army shooter Ajay Kumar
   gold · men's 10m air pistol

5. SUMMIT
   AI Impact Conference
   Lucknow

6. SPORTS
   Tamil Nadu
   gold · women's beach volleyball and men's regu pencak silat at Khelo India Beach Games

7. SUMMIT
   G7 Critical Minerals Ministerial Meeting
   Washington

8. SUMMIT
   86th All India Presiding Officers Conference (AIPOC)
   Lucknow

9. SUMMIT
   56th Annual Meeting of World Economic Forum
   Davos

10. SUMMIT
    9th International Conference
    Gandhinagar

SU Summits, conferences & meetings 7

💡 Asked as: “Where was the nth … Summit held?” — learn edition number ↔ host city/country.

EVENT	VENUE
AI Impact Summit	Bharat Mandapam
AI Impact Conference	Lucknow
G7 Critical Minerals Ministerial Meeting	Washington
86th All India Presiding Officers Conference (AIPOC)	Lucknow
56th Annual Meeting of World Economic Forum	Davos
9th International Conference	Gandhinagar
86th All India Presiding Officers’ Conference	Lucknow

AP Appointments 7

💡 Asked as: “Who has been appointed as …?” — learn the name ↔ post pair, and whether it is a first (first woman, first from…).

WHO	POST
Air Marshal Tejinder Singh	Air Officer Commanding-in-Chief South Western Air Command, Indian Air Force
Air Marshal Seethepalli Shrinivas	Air Officer Commanding- in-Chief Training Command, Indian Air Force
Mufti Noor Ahmad Noor	at Afghanistan Embassy in India
NIA	probe into major illegal Bangladeshi immigration racket
Gagan Kumar Thapa	Nepali Congress president at Special General Convention
Praveen Vashista	Vigilance Commissioner in the Central Vigilance Commission
Amelia Valverde	coach of senior Indian Women’s Football Team

AW Awards & honours 6

💡 Asked as: “Who won the … award/prize?” — Nobel, Booker and national awards are favourites.

AWARD	WINNER
world’s largest AI Film Award	Tunisian filmmaker Zoubeir Jlassi
SKOCH Award 2025	Centre for Development of Telematics (C-DOT)
Padmapani Award	Veteran music composer Ilaiyaraaja to be

AWARD	WINNER
SKOCH Award 2025	C-DOT
Subhas Chandra Bose National Award	Lieutenant Colonel Sita Ashok Shelke
this year's Padma Awards	131 distinguished personalities

SP Sports 4

💡 Asked as: "Who won gold/the title at …?" — athlete ↔ event ↔ medal.

WHO	WON	EVENT
National Shooting Championship: Army shooter Ajay Kumar	gold	men's 10m air pistol
Tamil Nadu	gold	women's beach volleyball and men's regu pencak silat at Khelo India Beach Games
ITBP	LG Cup Ice Hockey Championship	—
Tennis: Elena Rybakina	Australian Open Crown	—

DY Important days 11

💡 Asked as: "… Day is observed on?" and "What was this year's theme?" — learn date + theme.

DATE	DAY	THEME
reported 02/01	National Siddha Day	—
4 January	World Braille Day	—
reported 10/01	World Hindi Day	—
12 January	National Youth Day	—
reported 15/01	National Agricultural Biodiversity Day	—
reported 16/01	National Startup Day	—
24 January	National Girl Child Day	—
25 January	National Voters' Day	—
reported 27/01	International Data Privacy Day	—
reported 30/01	National Leprosy Day	—

DATE	DAY	THEME
2 February	World Wetlands Day	—

SC Schemes, portals & initiatives 23

💡 Asked as: “Which ministry launched …?” — scheme/portal ↔ ministry.

WHAT	BY
policy reforms to promote sustainable growth of NPS	Ministry of Finance
to Strengthen MSME Exports under Export Promotion Mission	Ministry of Commerce & Industry
Ph.D. Programme, Marking a New Academic Milestone in Its 60-Year Legacy	Ministry of Information & Broadcasting
PhD programme	Indian Institute of Mass Communication
interventions to boost MSME exports under Export Promotion Mission	Government
Ladakh Sports Policy 2025 in Leh	Lieutenant Governor Kavinder Gupta
second phase of specialised cancer care training Program for BIMSTEC countries in Visakhapatnam	MEA
IICA PGIP program Website	Ministry of Corporate Affairs
Annual Capacity-Building Webinar Programme for Creative Professionals	Ministry of Information & Broadcasting
PANKHUDI	Ministry of Women and Child Development
PANKHUDI portal to enhance ease of living for women & children	Union Minister Annpurna Devi
Internship Program and Dedicated Internship Portal to Nurture Future Professionals	Ministry of Road Transport & Highways
BJP’s ‘Mission 2026’ for Kerala Assembly Polls	Amit Shah
National Campaign on Entrepreneurship	Ministry of Rural Development
registration for 8th batch of Post Graduate Insolvency Programme	Ministry of Corporate Affairs
Responsible Nations Index	Former President Ramnath Kovind
NBEMS Online Training Programme on Artificial Intelligence in Medical Education	Ministry of Health and Family Welfare

WHAT	BY
online training programme on AI in Medical Education	Union Minister Anupriya Patel
ECINET digital platform at IICDEM 2026	Election Commission
Sampoornata Abhiyan 2.0 to accelerate development across Aspirational Districts & Blocks	NITI Aayog
Aadhaar app on occasion of Unique Identification Authority of India day	MoS Jitin Prasada
two additional modules, named Survey Module and Waqf Property Lease Module on the UMEED Central Portal	Ministry of Minority Affairs
Survey Module and Waqf Property Lease Module on UMEED Portal	Govt

CB Cabinet decisions 2

💡 Banking & UPSC ask the numbers: outlay (₹ crore), number of projects/schools, the year.

equity support to Small Industries Development Bank of India

continuation of Atal Pension Yojana (APY) and extension of funding support for promotional and developmental activities and gap funding till 2030-31

₹ Banking corner (RBI)

💡 Banking exams: which bank was penalised / whose licence was cancelled, and RBI's new rules.

Licence cancelled (1)

- 35 NBFCs

Monetary penalty imposed on (11)

- Sankhya Financial Services Private Limited, Mumbai
- Shaha Finlease Private Limited, Mumbai
- Jila Sahakari Bank Limited, Mau, Uttar Pradesh
- Pinnacle Capital Solutions Private Limited, Jharkhand
- The Nandura Urban Co-operative Bank Ltd., Nandura, Maharashtra
- Sri Satya Sai Nagrik Sahakari Bank Maryadit, Bhopal, Madhya Pradesh
- Shri Kanyaka Nagari Sahakari Bank Ltd., Chandrapur, Maharashtra
- Pimpri Chinchwad Sahakari Bank Maryadit, Pimpri, Maharashtra
- VSJ Investments Private Limited, Mumbai, Maharashtra

- Rajapur Urban Co-operative Bank Ltd., Rajapur, Maharashtra
- Northern Arc Capital Limited

Rankings & indices 3

Union Minister J P Nadda informs India stands at 8th position globally in WHO Pharmacovigilance Contributions

India's Innovation Performance Strengthens Steadily, Global Innovation Index Rank Improves to 38th in 2025 from 66th in 2019: Economic Survey 2025-26

India climbs to 38th rank in global innovation index 2025 from 66th in 2019

Fast facts by topic

Banking & Economy

- Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman to present Union Budget 2026-27 tomorrow
- Government debunks claims of removal of food, education from CPI inflation calculation
- Bangladesh: IMF warns against unsecured support to weak banks
- Union Minister Piyush Goyal asserts India's exports to the European Union can double in five years
- Financial Services Dept Secretary holds review meeting on Regional Rural Banks' performance
- Govt debunks message claiming leak of scanned copy of Union Budget 2026–27
- Finance Minister to interact with over 30 college students nationwide after Union Budget 2026-27 presentation
- Finance Minister to present Union Budget 2026-27 on Feb 1

Defence & Security

- South Korea, Japan Agree to Resume Naval Search and Rescue Exercises After 9 Years
- Run with the Navy: Second Edition of Indian Navy Half Marathon in New Delhi
- MoS Defence Sanjay Seth presents awards for Best Contingents and Tableaux of R-Day Parade 2026
- Indian Navy's First Training Squadron Concludes Visit to Phuket Deep Sea Port, Thailand
- SC says additions, deletions part of electoral roll revision exercise undertaken by ECI
- Operation Sindoor demonstrated that indigenous systems are strengthening India's operational readiness: Defence Minister Rajnath Singh
- DRDO has played vital role in strengthening nation's security framework by developing advanced tech: Defence Minister Rajnath Singh
- Defence Minister Rajnath Singh reaffirms country's growing partnership with European Union

Science & Technology

- CCRAS Concludes Internship Programme on Information Technology in Ayush
- Govt startup accelerator platform, WaveX, invites applications for participation in India AI Impact Summit 2026
- Dr Jitendra Singh inaugurates Rs 32 crore CSIR-NIO Shore-Based Regional Centre at Visakhapatnam
- WaveX Invites Applications for India AI Impact Summit 2026
- India AI Impact Summit Receives Phenomenal Global Response, India's AI Ecosystem Developing in a Systematic Manner: Union Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw
- PM Modi Calls for Transparent, Impartial and Secure AI Ecosystem
- India, EU reaffirm strategic cooperation in next-gen digital technologies, including 6G
- US President urges Iran to negotiate nuclear deal, warns of stronger action

Sports

- Badminton: Devika Sihag Storms into Thailand Masters 2026 Final
- India's strategy, plan & vision to contribute to Olympic movement: Director of IOA, Makis Asimakopoulos
- Jharkhand, Uttarakhand, Andhra Pradesh among winners on third day of U-17 Hockey Championship
- Impressed with India's strategy, plan and vision to contribute to the Olympic movement: Makis Asimakopoulos, Director, International Olympic Academy
- Men's Under-19 Cricket World Cup: India defeats Zimbabwe by 204 runs in Super Six stage match at Bulawayo
- President Murmu awarded Distinguished Service Medals to Railway officers & special forces
- 982 personnel awarded Gallantry and Service Medals on Republic Day
- ICC announces Scotland will replace Bangladesh in Group C of the T20 World Cup

Awards & Honours

- Union Minister of State (Independent Charge) for AYUSH Shri Prataprao Jadhav Congratulates Padma Shri Dr. Padma Gurmet, Director, NISR Leh
- IEW 2026 Concludes with Awards Recognising Innovation and Leadership in Energy
- Raksha Rajya Mantri gives away awards to Best Marching Contingents & Best Tableaux of Republic Day Parade 2026
- Ministry of Culture Tableau on 'Vande Mataram - 150 Years Journey' Wins First Prize at Republic Day 2026 parade
- Union Minister of State Prof. S. P. Singh Baghel Confers National Model Youth Gram Sabha Awards in New Delhi
- National Awards for Model Youth Gram Sabha to Be Conferred in New Delhi Tomorrow
- Union Home Minister and Minister of Cooperation, Shri Amit Shah, congratulates the individuals selected for the Padma Awards from various states
- K. Pajanivel conferred with Padma Shri for traditional martial arts

International Relations

- EAM S Jaishankar meets Oman Foreign Minister Badr Albusaidi, Discusses Trade & Regional Issues
- Union Minister Savitri Thakur to lead Indian delegation at the 64th Session of United Nations Commission for Social Development
- UN could run out of cash for its regular operation, says UN Chief Antonio Guterres
- PM Modi & Venezuela's Acting President agree to deepen bilateral ties
- MoS for Women and Child Development, Smt. Savitri Thakur to lead Indian delegation at 64th Session of the United Nations Commission for Social Development
- MoU Signing Ceremony between CCRAS and Berhampur University to Digitize Rare Ayurvedic Manuscripts
- EAM Dr S Jaishankar holds meeting with his Sudan counterpart, Salim Ahmed Ibrahim, in New Delhi
- Kurdish-led Syrian Democratic Force announces new agreement with government

Polity & Governance

- President Murmu greets people on eve of birth anniversary of Guru Ravidas
- Bharat Parv reflects India's unity in diversity: Vice President Shri C. P. Radhakrishnan
- Vice-President Shri C. P. Radhakrishnan inaugurates 39th Surajkund International Atmanirbhar Crafts Mela in Faridabad
- Vice-President Shri C. P. Radhakrishnan attends closing ceremony of Bharat Parv 2026 at Red Fort Lawns
- US President Trump nominates former Federal Reserve Governor Kevin Warsh as his preferred successor
- Lieutenant Governor Manoj Sinha says Mahatma Gandhi's ideals of non-violence, truth & human dignity remain relevant for world
- Nation remembers Mahatma Gandhi on his death anniversary; President, Vice President and PM pay tribute
- Parliamentary delegation from Republic of Korea calls on Shri Harivansh, Hon'ble Deputy Chairman, Rajya Sabha

Appointments

- Panchayati Raj Ministry to felicitate elected Panchayat representatives in New Delhi today
- Women Constables Appointed in Large Numbers Through Rozgar Mela: Union Minister Dr Jitendra Singh
- PM Modi to distribute over 61 thousand appointment letters to newly appointed youth at 18th Rozgar Mela
- Under Rozgar Mela, PM to distribute more than 61,000 appointment letters to the newly appointed youth in Government on 24th January

Environment

- Patna Bird Sanctuary and Chhari-Dhand Added to India's Ramsar Sites List
- Environment Minister Bhupender Yadav announces addition of two new wetlands to India's Ramsar network
- PM Modi expresses happiness over inclusion of Patna Bird Sanctuary & Chhari-Dhand in Ramsar sites list
- Prime Minister welcomes new Ramsar sites at Patna Bird Sanctuary and Chhari-Dhand
- National Biodiversity Authority Disburses Rs 17 Lakh to Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation Under ABS Mechanism
- MoS Jitendra Singh says issue of climate change cannot be solved without collective efforts
- CAQM reviews Annual Action Plans and key sectoral measures towards abatement of air pollution in Rajasthan (NCR)
- MoEFCC issues notification declaring Kumbhalgarh Wildlife Sanctuary in Aravalli mountain range as Eco-Sensitive Zone

Schemes & Initiatives

- BLA Launches Operation Herof Phase 2 Across Balochistan
- SAIL launches nationwide creative contest 'SAIL-e-BRATION: Steel Built India, SAIL Built Trust'
- Union Minister Amit Shah addresses workers' conference in Barrackpore, West Bengal
- Over 25 crore cards issued to farmers under Soil Health Card Scheme, launched in 2015 to address decline of soil nutrients
- Union Minister Kirti Vradhan Singh inaugurates India-Arab Countries Chamber of Commerce, Industry & Agriculture in New Delhi
- Lakshya Zero Dumpsite: India's Drive to Eliminate City Dumpsites Under Swachh Bharat Mission
- SAIL Launches "सेल-e-BRATION": A National Creative Challenge to Celebrate the 'Steel-to-Soul' Connection
- Union Health Minister Shri Jagat Prakash Nadda Addresses NCW Foundation Day Programme

Important Days

- 77th Republic Day Parade Reflected India's Unity in Diversity: VP Radhakrishnan
- PM Modi to visit Punjab on Sant Guru Ravidas' 649th birth anniversary on Feb 1
- On the occasion of the 649th Birth Anniversary of Sant Guru Ravidas Ji, PM to visit Punjab on 1st February
- Tribal Affairs Minister Jual Oram says tribal guests invited to Republic Day Celebrations 2026 carry forward spirit of today's India
- VP Radhakrishnan pays floral tributes to Father of Nation, Mahatma Gandhi, on his death anniversary
- India Energy Week 2026 concludes; Union Minister Hardeep Singh Puri calls it reassuring and impactful
- National Commission for Women marks its 34th Foundation Day today
- Ministry of Tribal Affairs Hosts Reception for Tribal Guests Invited to Republic Day Celebrations 2026

? Practice MCQs (15)

Exam-style questions. Tap an option to check yourself instantly.

Q1. **Who won gold at women's beach volleyball and men's regu pencak silat at Khelo India Beach Games in January 2026?**

A Olympian Gurpreet Singh
B Kajal Dhochak
C Tamil Nadu
D Ayush Shetty

Q2. **Who took charge as Air Officer Commanding-in-Chief South Western Air Command, Indian Air Force in January 2026?**

A Air Marshal Tejinder Singh
B Vice President M Venkaiah Naidu
C Lt Gen Dhiraj Seth
D Air Marshal Vivek Hande

Q3. **Who won the Subhas Chandra Bose National Award?**

A Telecommunications Consultants India Limited (TCIL)
B Lieutenant Colonel Sita Ashok Shelke
C National Council of Science Museums
D Defence Estates Organisation under MoD

Q4. **Who took charge as probe into major illegal Bangladeshi immigration racket in January 2026?**

A Tom Suozzi
B Harivansh
C NIA
D Mufti Noor Ahmad Noor

Q5. **Who took charge as at Afghanistan Embassy in India in January 2026?**

A Djibouti President Ismail Omar Guelleh
B Vice Admiral Vineet McCarty
C Vice Admiral B Sivakumar
D Mufti Noor Ahmad Noor

Q6. **Who was elected as Nepali Congress president at Special General Convention in January 2026?**

A Bharat Khera
B Gagan Kumar Thapa
C Anupam Misra
D Tarun Kumar Pithode

Q7. **Who won the SKOCH Award 2025?**

A him
B e-Jagriti
C ICMR
D C-DOT

Q8. **Where was the AI Impact Conference held?**

A Bishkek
B Nairobi
C Auli
D Lucknow

Q9. **Who took charge as Air Officer Commanding- in-Chief Training Command, Indian Air Force in January 2026?**

A Vice Admiral Manish Chadha

B Air Marshal Vivek Hande

C Air Marshal Tejpal Singh

D Air Marshal Seethepalli Shrinivas

Q10. **Where was the AI Impact Summit held?**

A Cape Town

B Bharat Mandapam

C Nagpur, Maharashtra

D Southern Naval

Q11. **Who won the SKOCH Award 2025?**

A Centre for Development of Telematics (C-DOT)

B Vanuatu Law Students, Lawyer Julian Aguon

C Former CJI Justice Dipak Misra

D Telecommunications Consultants India Limited (TCIL)

Q12. **Where was the 86th All India Presiding Officers Conference (AIPOC) held?**

A Namangan

B Nagpur

C Lucknow

D Jakarta

Q13. **Who won the world's largest AI Film Award?**

A Defence Estates Organisation under MoD

B ACS Supriya Sahu of Tamil Nadu

C Science City Kolkata's Climate Change Gallery

D Tunisian filmmaker Zoubeir Jlassi

Q14. **Who was appointed as Vigilance Commissioner in the Central Vigilance Commission in January 2026?**

A Yumnam Khemchand Singh

B Archana Varma

C Bhagwat Prasad Makwana

D Praveen Vashista

Q15. **Where was the G7 Critical Minerals Ministerial Meeting held?**

A Itanagar

B Washington

C Faridabad

D Auli

Answer key

1-C 2-A 3-B 4-C 5-D 6-B 7-D 8-D 9-D 10-B 11-A 12-C 13-D 14-D 15-B

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